

SkinCare App — External Services Required

Third-party accounts and credentials needed from the client for a full production launch

Project: SkinCare Consultation App (User + Doctor app, Admin Dashboard, Backend API)

Prepared for: Client

Purpose: Production-readiness checklist of external service accounts

Summary

#	Service	Used for	Status
1	SMS / OTP Provider	Phone number login verification	REQUIRED
2	Firebase	Push notifications (case updates, chat, calls)	REQUIRED
3	Agora	Doctor–patient video consultations	REQUIRED
4	Cloudinary	Storing photos, prescriptions, avatars	TEMPORARILY CONFIGURED
5	PostgreSQL Database Hosting	Storing all app data	REQUIRED
6	Backend Hosting Platform	Running the server so the app can connect to it	REQUIRED

1. SMS / OTP Provider

Phone number login verification REQUIRED — SECURITY

Where it's used	Login screen (User & Doctor app) — a user enters their phone number and receives a one-time code (OTP) to verify it's really them.
Current status	Not yet connected to a real SMS provider. Right now, the app accepts any 6-digit code during testing, so anyone could log in with any phone number. This must be fixed with a real provider before the app is used by real patients and doctors.
What's needed	An account with an SMS/OTP delivery service. Common choices: MSG91 , Twilio , or Firebase Phone Authentication (which reuses the Firebase project from item 2 below, so it can save you creating a separate account).
What to provide us	Account API key/credentials once the account is created (or confirmation to use Firebase Phone Auth instead, if preferred).

2. Firebase (Push Notifications)

Case updates, chat messages, call reminders

REQUIRED

Where it's used	Sends a notification to a patient's or doctor's phone when: a case is assigned to a doctor, a new chat message arrives, a video call is scheduled, or the admin sends a broadcast announcement.
Current status	The server-side code is ready and waiting for credentials (falls back to just logging to console right now, so no real notification is sent to a phone yet).
What's needed	A free Firebase project (created at console.firebase.google.com) with Cloud Messaging enabled.
What to provide us	- A Firebase service account key (Project Settings → Service Accounts → Generate new private key) — used by our server to send notifications. - The google-services.json file (for Android) and GoogleService-Info.plist file (for iOS), downloaded from the same Firebase project — used inside the mobile app itself so it can receive notifications on the device.

3. Agora (Video Consultations)

Doctor–patient live video calls

REQUIRED

Where it's used	When a doctor schedules and starts a video consultation with a patient from within a case.
Current status	Server-side code is ready; currently uses a placeholder token, so real video calls cannot connect yet.
What's needed	A free/paid Agora account (created at agora.io) with a new project.
What to provide us	The project's App ID and App Certificate , found in the Agora Console under Project Management.

4. Cloudinary (Media Storage)

Case photos, prescription attachments, profile pictures

TEMPORARILY CONFIGURED

Where it's used	Every photo or file uploaded in the app — patient case photos, doctor's prescription attachments, profile avatars, chat images — is stored here instead of on the server itself.
Current status	Already working, using a temporary developer Cloudinary account for testing. This should be swapped for the client's own account before launch, so all files live under the client's ownership.
What's needed	A free/paid Cloudinary account (created at cloudinary.com).
What to provide us	The Cloud name , API Key , and API Secret shown on the Cloudinary dashboard homepage.

5. PostgreSQL Database Hosting

Stores all app data

REQUIRED

Where it's used	Every user, doctor, case, chat message, prescription, notification, and admin record is stored in this database.
Current status	Runs on a local test database right now. A production database must be created before real users start using the app, so no data is lost or reset accidentally.
What's needed	A production PostgreSQL database. This is not tied to any one company — it can be created directly on whichever hosting platform is chosen for the backend server (see item 6), which is usually the simplest option.
What to provide us	Nothing extra if it's created on the same hosting platform as the backend — we will set it up as part of deployment. Otherwise, a database connection string.

6. Backend Hosting Platform

Where the server actually runs

REQUIRED

Where it's used	The backend server that the User app, Doctor app, and Admin Dashboard all talk to. Without this, none of the apps can function outside of local testing.
Current status	Currently only running locally, for development and testing.
What's needed	An account on a hosting platform such as Render (recommended — simple and affordable) or similar.
What to provide us	Access to the hosting account, or approval for us to create one on the client's behalf/billing.
Note	Uploaded files need a small paid "persistent storage" add-on on most platforms unless Cloudinary (item 4) is used for everything — since Cloudinary is already wired in, this becomes optional rather than required.

Priority suggestion: To go live safely and completely, the most urgent items are the SMS/OTP provider (#1 — a real security requirement, not just a feature) and Firebase (#2). Agora (#3) is needed as soon as video consultations should work for real. Database and hosting (#5, #6) are needed together, typically set up in the same step.